



Kehilat Shaare *Shalom* ב"ש

HaRav David Rubinoff, Shlita · 22 Andover Lane, Woodmere

— SHABBAT MEVARCHIM —

Parshat *Bamidbar*

May 15–16, 2026 · Iyar 28–29, 5786

*This newsletter is dedicated L'ilui Nishmat
Lillya Leah Rena Bat Genya (Rubinoff), A"H*

Shabbat Schedule

FRIDAY NIGHT

Candle Lighting	7:45
Shir Hashirim	7:00
Mincha & Kabbalat Shabbat	7:15
Shkia (Sunset)	8:05
Tzeit HaKochavim	8:23

SHABBAT MORNING

Ben Ish Hai Class	8:00
Shacharit · Korbanot	8:30
Shacharit · Hodu	8:45
LATEST SHEMA	
M"A 8:26	Gr"A 9:14
Rabbi's Morning Speech	10:50

SHABBAT AFTERNOON

Chazot (Midday)	12:51
Kids program with Avi	5:15
Ladies Tehillim & Brachot	6:00
Parsha Shiur	6:45
Mincha	7:15
Arvit	8:30
Shabbat Ends	8:45
Rabbenu Tam	9:18

WEEKDAY MINYANIM

Daily Schedule

SUNDAY
Shacharit · 7:45 AM

MON – FRI
Shacharit · 6:00 AM **NEW**

DAILY
Mincha & Arvit · 7:15 PM

— A RESPECTFUL REQUEST —

To preserve the dignity and flow of the Rabbi's Shabbat afternoon shiur, we kindly ask attendees to arrive on time and avoid unnecessary movement or interruptions once the shiur has begun. Thank you for helping maintain a respectful environment for all.

— WITH GRATITUDE —

This Week's *Sponsors*

LAVISH KIDDUSH
Kamy Beroukhim & Family

· and ·

Aron Rubinov

*L'ilui Nishmat Yonatan Ben Rachamim · In honor
of Miriam & Rephael's birthdays*

LADIES BRACHOT PARTY
Kamy Beroukhim & Family
L'ilui Nishmat Yonatan Ben Rachamim

SEUDAT SHLISHIT
Kamy Beroukhim & Family
L'ilui Nishmat Yonatan Ben Rachamim

BALANCES

If you have an outstanding balance, please make every effort to settle it. Payment may be made by Zelle to ksswoodmere@gmail.com, or by check or credit card directly to the Shul.

Shabbat *Shalom*



— RABBI RUBINOFF'S WEEKLY MESSAGE —

Internal Influencer

On Parshat Bamidbar

וַיִּתְּלֻם עַל־מִשְׁפָּחָתָם לְבֵית אֲבֹתָם

“And they declared their families' bloodlines through the houses of their fathers.”

Sefer Bamidbar opens with a census of the Jewish people. Each family belonging to each tribe was individually counted, and the final tally was brought to Moshe Rabbenu. The Rabbis present a beautiful idea based on the verse above — *“they declared their families' bloodlines through the houses of their fathers”* — that children are heavily influenced by their parents' actions, and the qualities of a mother or father can be seen clearly in their children.

On the optimistic side, if a father is meticulous to pray three times a day with a minyan, chances are his sons will do the same. If a son sees his father constantly giving charity, learning Torah, and performing acts of kindness, the odds are he will follow in his footsteps. On the pessimistic side, if a child sees his parents caring only about materialism, constantly on their smart phones, and never giving the time of day for matters of a spiritual nature, the children will follow suit.

Last Friday, I joined the 6th and 7th grade boys of Yeshiva Darchei Torah for their weekly *Sihah Mussar* given by the Rosh Hayeshiva, **Rabbi Yaakov Bender**. In his speech, Rabbi Bender was admonishing the boys for not properly washing *netilat yadayim* before eating the school's freshly baked breakfast rolls. He pointed out that if the yeshiva is providing free bread, the students must follow the school rules and wash their hands as the Halacha demands — otherwise they would be considered as stealing. Even though not all boys were derelict in this mitzvah, it was important that everyone hear.

After he finished speaking, I was reminded of a story about the **Ben Ish Hai** (Hacham Yosef Haim, Bagdad 1834–1909). A father once approached the Hacham and complained that he had witnessed his child eat bread without washing *netilat yadayim*. “I was so angry,” said the father, “that I grabbed the shoehorn hanging on the wall, meaning to hit him. As my arm swung down he moved, and instead of hitting him I struck my own hand. It immediately swelled up and turned black and blue. I don't understand what Hashem is trying to tell me — I'm trying to discipline my child, and my body gets punished instead?”

The Ben Ish Hai glared at the father and asked, “Be honest — are you careful to always wash *netilat yadayim* before eating bread?” The father's face turned red. He admitted that sometimes, when he's in a rush, he doesn't wash. The Ben Ish Hai then told him that he himself was to blame for his son's actions, and that is why his hand was punished.

As I pondered this story, a few of the boys — myself included — approached Rabbi Bender after his speech to hear his post-thoughts. Everyone had already left the auditorium, so it was just us, lucky enough to be the private audience of this legendary master of children's education. He looked at us and apologized for being so harsh. Then he said: “Truth is, it's not even the students' fault for not washing. I blame their parents, who didn't train them properly by practicing this mitzvah on their own.” I smiled to myself as the Rosh Yeshiva echoed the words of the Ben Ish Hai, spoken over one hundred years ago.

A similar — and comical — story happened to **Rav Aaron Leib Shteinman** (Bnei Brak 1914–2017). A father came to him and shared that his three-year-old daughter had been acting very strange. For the past few months, she'd been taking the laces off everyone's shoes and tying them around her arm. All day long she wrapped her arm with shoelaces. “Rebbe,” said the father, “maybe my child is suffering from some sort of mental disorder — should I take her to see a psychologist?”

Rav Aaron Leib smiled and said: “Your daughter is perfectly healthy and doesn't need a psychologist. Stop putting on tefilin at home and start going to shul, and you'll see — she'll stop wrapping shoelaces around her arm. Your daughter is just copying what she sees at home.”

The Gemara in *Massechet Succah* (56) writes that whatever a child speaks in the marketplace is what they have heard from their parents at home. That is the interpretation of our verse: “they declared their families' bloodlines through the houses of their fathers.” A child observes his parents' behavior and understands what they consider important or insignificant — and that has a tremendous effect on how they will act in life. A parent is his or her child's *internal influencer*.

Shabbat Shalom

— RAV DAVID RUBINOFF —